

Tableau Quick Revision Notes

Quick Revision Notes · by Mahendra Singh · CrackAnalytics

Filter order of execution (most-asked!)

Extract → Data Source → Context → Dimension → Measure → Table Calculation. Context filters create a temp subset; Top-N and FIXED LODs respect context but ignore normal dimension filters.

Connections & files

- **Live** real-time, DB-dependent speed · **Extract (.hyper)** fast snapshot, schedule refreshes
- Incremental refresh appends new rows by a date/ID column; still do periodic full refresh
- .twb workbook only · .twbx packaged (+data) · .tds/.tdsx data source · .tfl Prep flow

Blending vs Join

- Join: same source, row level, before aggregation · Blend: different sources, after aggregation, behaves like LEFT join from primary
- * asterisk = multiple secondary values matched one primary row — fix the blend level
- Cross-database join: add both connections in ONE data source and join

LOD expressions

```
{FIXED [Customer]: SUM([Sales])} -- customer lifetime value on every row
{INCLUDE [Order]: SUM([Sales])} -- add detail below view level
{EXCLUDE [City]: SUM([Sales])} -- regional total beside each city
Cohort: {FIXED [Customer]: MIN([Order Date])}
```

Calculations cheat list

```
DATEDIFF('day', [Start], [End]) -- days between
DATEADD('day', -1, DATETRUNC('month', TODAY())) -- last day of prev month
SPLIT([Name], ' ', -1) -- last name
ZN([Sales]) -- null -> 0
RANK(SUM([Sales])) -- ranking in view
```

Sets vs Groups vs Parameters

- **Group** — static relabeling of members · **Set** — dynamic in/out by condition (Top 10) · **Parameter** — single user input powering calcs/filters/Top N

Performance & Server

- Performance Recording first → fix biggest: extract instead of live, fewer quick filters ('Only relevant values' is costly), fewer marks, aggregate data
- RLS: USERNAME() = [User Email] as a DATA SOURCE filter (locked), or entitlement table
- Server processes: Gateway · VizPortal · VizQL · Backgrounder (refreshes) · Repository (PostgreSQL) · Hyper
- Permissions: site role caps ability; content rules — DENY beats allow; manage via groups at project level